

2025-2026



ANNUAL IMPACT STATEMENT

WILLIAMSBURG-
JAMES CITY COUNTY
PUBLIC SCHOOLS



WHRO Annual Impact Statement

2025-26

Williamsburg-James City County Public Schools

Regional Leadership

HRETA Educational Advisory Committee

Randy Riffle

HRETA Superintendents Advisory Council

Dr. Daniel Keever

HRETA Technology Advisory Committee

Brian Landers

Consortium for Interactive Instruction

Kristin Barr
Whitney Oberndorf

Online Learning System Administrators

Whitney Oberndorf
Kristin Barr

Please see the “Notes” section on page 15 for complete descriptions of these groups.

Executive Summary:

WHRO Annual Impact Statement 2025-26

The 2025-2026 Annual Impact Statement highlights the educational services and resources provided by WHRO, underscoring significant advancements in educational technology, resources, and student enrichment across the region.

Digital and Instructional Resources

WHRO's **eMediaVASM** is a free digital media platform that supports over 600,000 user accounts statewide, providing Virginia-aligned, high-quality content from trusted sources (e.g., PBS, NASA, Smithsonian). Recent platform upgrades included improved search functionality, SOL filter updates, and site load optimization.

Online Learning

WHRO's thirty online courses are meticulously aligned with the Virginia Standards of Learning and accessible via multiple learning management systems. During 2025-26, a fifth course, English 9, was awarded the Quality Matters certification.

Family and Early Learner Outreach

WHRO delivered comprehensive early childhood services, including Ready to Learn programming, STEM and Literacy Vans, Environmental Education Vans, and in-person reading camps. In 2025-26, WHRO's children's services reached nearly 18,000 children region-wide, providing thousands of books and hands-on learning experiences. Early learning was further reinforced through ongoing parent trainings, creative camps, library corners, and mobile resources.

Professional Development

WHRO's professional development programs engaged more than 800 educators.

Special Initiatives & Student Competitions

Key initiatives included the Batten Environmental Education Initiative (with a new middle school van program) and the WHRO Student Advisory Board. WHRO also provided opportunities for student work to be recognized through the PBS KIDS Writers Contest, Spelling Bee, and Great Computer Challenges.

Media & Community Engagement

WHRO KIDS delivered 24/7 high-quality children's educational TV, backed by online and streaming access. General PBS and NPR programming provided additional enrichment, while local productions like "Education Matters" and "Ms. Martha Reads" spotlighted local voices and literacy.

Return on Investment

Williamsburg-James City County Public Schools invested \$40,710.52 in WHRO services during 2025-26 and received direct and indirect benefits valued at \$1,523,724.00—a **remarkable return of \$37.45 for every \$1 invested**. WHRO's region-wide programming not only delivered fiscal savings but also elevated educational opportunity, professional development, and family enrichment for Williamsburg-JCC's students, educators, and community.

Conclusion

WHRO's robust services, outlined in greater detail in this document, provided substantial value for HRETA school divisions, utilizing a collaborative model that enhanced teaching, learning, and community engagement well beyond the classroom.



eMediaVASM (www.emediava.org)

eMediaVA is a WHRO service supported by the Virginia General Assembly through the Virginia Department of Education (VDOE), along with leading national and Virginia-based educational content providers. It serves as a one-stop platform for high-quality digital resources for Virginia's Pre-K–12 teachers and students.

The platform features content from trusted sources such as PBS, NASA, the Smithsonian, Colonial Williamsburg, the National Archives, NPR, Virginia's public media stations, Old Dominion University, the Science Museum of Virginia, Norfolk Public Library, and many more. All resources are aligned with Virginia's Standards of Learning and are free for all educators and students statewide. As of June 30, 2026, eMediaVA had over 600,000 user accounts—an increase of 65,000 from the previous year.

eMediaVA 4.0 offers a modern, device-responsive interface with enhanced features, including:

- Curated collections and highlighted resources
- Multilingual filters
- News and events updates
- A fuzzy search engine that accounts for misspellings
- Grade-level filters to help younger students find age-appropriate content
- Division-level content controls

To simplify access and account management, eMediaVA integrates with Clever and ClassLink for Single Sign-On (SSO) and supports Learning Tools Interoperability (LTI) with platforms like Canvas. Currently, 119 school divisions across Virginia, including all of the HRETA divisions, have established SSO with eMediaVA.

Regional Savings/Value: \$996,200.00

Williamsburg-JCC Savings/Value^A: \$47,985.00

***"Lots of great content that's free and easy to share, embed, etc. in platforms."
– Teacher, Newport News Public Schools***

Families and Early Learners

Ready to Learn was a national partnership between Congress, the U.S. Department of Education, CPB, PBS, local public media stations like WHRO, and community organizations. The initiative offered non-commercial educational programming, online games, skill trackers, and other resources for children, parents, caregivers, and educators—all designed to prepare young learners for school success. Many of these resources continue to be utilized by WHRO.



Combined, WHRO delivered more than 12,000 hours of the best high-quality Educational Early Childhood Programming last year on WHRO KIDS 15.3 and on WHRO 15.1 free of charge to every household in greater Hampton Roads. WHRO KIDS also provides a 24/7 streaming service that can be used on any mobile device.



The **WHRO STEM Van**, equipped with 20 iPads, 12 Chromebooks, and two touchscreen monitors, brings hands-on learning directly to students. During the 2025-26 school year, WHRO staff conducted 100 school and community visits, providing resources and STEM activities aligned with Virginia's Standards of Learning. Lessons used PBS KIDS curriculum

based on the engineering design process. The program is supported by foundation donations and corporate underwriting.

"...thank you for joining us at STEAM Night last night! Having you there, especially with the Scratch Jr. coding station, was such a huge win." – Teacher, Chesapeake

The **WHRO Literacy Van** is a colorful, mobile program that promotes daily reading across the region. Aimed at Pre-K through second-grade students, the program features storytelling and literacy activities aligned with Pre-K Comprehensive Standards and Virginia's Standards of Learning to inspire a love of reading. After each session, children take a "Reader's Pledge" to read every day and are invited to tour the van, which is filled with books. These books are distributed to children in high-need areas or added to classroom libraries. The van also regularly delivers *First Book* and other literacy resources to Title I schools serving grades K–5. During the 2025-26 school year, the Literacy Van made 39 school and community visits.

The **Batten Environmental Education Van** program offers classroom teachers SOL-aligned lesson plans and digital activities tied to the GreenBeatsSM video series. The van is equipped with 30 Surface Pro tablets and four large-screen computers, featuring digital interactives developed by WHRO's learning team. These resources help inspire young students across the region to protect the environment. In the 2025-26 school year, the van visited 9 schools and community sites.

"Thank you so much for a wonderful in-house field trip! The children loved the hands-on learning, especially planting the seeds and the green activity books." - Teacher, Virginia Beach

Super WHY! Reading Camps are multi-day, interactive learning adventures that show campers ages 4-5 the power of reading, and motivate them to play with letters, sounds, and words through a comprehensive curriculum developed by noted literacy experts. Twenty-seven camps reaching nearly 500 children have been conducted since the initiative began in 2008 when WHRO held its first Super WHY! Reading Camp at Fort Story Army Base Child Development Center and participated in a study by Florida State University's Center for Reading Research. Campers showed gains in all of the literacy skills presented in the program, including an 84% gain in phonics skills and a 139% gain in word recognition skills.

PBS KIDS ScratchJr Coding Camps are one-, three-, or five-day afterschool programs, in which first, second, and third-grade students are introduced to creative coding through digital and physical activities and given the opportunity to create their own stories, games, and collages with the PBS KIDS ScratchJr tablet app.

STEM Camps are one-, three-, or five-day programs, in which kindergarten through third-grade students are introduced to various fun, curriculum-based activities focused on segments from PBS KIDS programming. Students are engaged in hands-on, collaborative, and playful learning, using both digital and tangible tools to support the development of their STEM skills in investigation and problem-solving.

WHRO Library Corners are decorated with PBS KIDS décor and provide a wealth of fun educational resources and literacy activities for children to use when visiting the library. Our first corner was established at the Dr. Clarence Cuffee Library in Chesapeake. During the 2025-26 school year, WHRO continued to support library corners at the following locations:

- Hampton Public Library, Main Library
- Portsmouth Public Library, Main Library and Craddock Branch Library
- Poquoson Public Library, Poquoson
- Suffolk Public Library, Morgan Memorial Library
- Virginia Beach Public Library, Windsor Woods Area Library

Anytime Is Learning Time Training helps parents identify everyday teachable moments. Parents attending these trainings receive helpful PBS parent resources, tip sheets, and free books for their children. WHRO works with parent liaisons to set up trainings for parents in Title I schools, Head Start Centers, and childcare providers.

WHRO, in partnership with **Lantern** (formerly Bright by Text), has established a service to deliver free parenting tips by text to parents of children age 8 and younger. After signing up, parents receive weekly messages customized to the child's age. These messages touch on ways that parents can promote healthy social, emotional, physical, and intellectual growth. Content comes from trusted national providers such as PBS KIDS, No Kid Hungry, Sesame Street in Communities, and Center for Early Learning + Public Health.

PBS KIDS content, including the WHRO KIDS 24/7 stream, is located on the Kids & Family page of WHRO's main website, where there is a wealth of articles and education tips for parents. This page also provides information about our WHRO KIDS 24/7 channel and media player.



The **PBS KIDS Website** (www.pbskids.org) is an engaging multimedia destination specifically created for kids ages 2-8. With fun, quirky settings full of surprises, this site empowers kids to discover themselves, define the diverse world around them, explore new relationships, and embrace a love of learning. The website features popular age-appropriate PBS series. Video clips, activities, apps, augmented reality games, and behind-the-scenes features are also available.

Title I School Resources – Superintendents and school representatives are kept up-to-date on Children's Services initiatives and activities through regular Educational Advisory Committee HRETA reports. These literacy and STEM resources and materials are regularly provided to Title I schools in all of WHRO's owner-member school divisions as requested.

Every year, WHRO distributes thousands of books to students. These efforts, funded through grants, local foundations, and WHRO's Hunter B. Andrews Society book drives, provide support to allow children in challenging circumstances to start their own libraries. Books are distributed after parent and provider trainings, after WHRO van visits, and at other community events. During the 2025-26 school year, WHRO distributed more than 13,450 books to area students.

Each year, WHRO is a major sponsor of the **Virginia Children's Festival** and has brought headline acts such as Maria and Elmo from Sesame Street, Mr. Steve of SteveSongs (a PBS personality), and Shock from The Electric Company. In addition, WHRO also secures PBS Costume Characters such as Super WHY!, Curious George, Word Girl, Nature Cat, SID The Science Kid, and Daniel Tiger. At this event, WHRO distributes hundreds of free books and provides hands-on experiences utilizing iPads and touch screens, allowing children to experience all of the interactive, engaging, educational content now available online.

During the 2025-26 school year, WHRO continued its weekly Facebook streaming service to address literacy skills for young learners. **Ms. Martha Reads** features children's services manager, Martha Razor, reading select student-written stories from past Young Storytellers contests. This award-winning program strengthens literacy skills while highlighting student drawing and writing. Averaging 6,000 page views per week, this program continues to be very popular.

Overall, in 2025-26, WHRO Children's Services reached more than 17,230 families, 1,560 caregivers/teachers, and 17,800 children. In addition, we distributed more than 4,500 First Books and nearly 9,000 activity Fun Books to children most in need.

Williamsburg-JCC Participants:

WHRO Education staff supported career awareness and student engagement by participating in Career Day at James River Elementary School. Staff shared information with more than 85 students about careers in public media and education, highlighting the role of storytelling, technology, and community service in WHRO's work. The staff also delivered 85 Fun Books to the students.

Total Regional Savings/Value: \$234,635.00 (For all items above)

Total Williamsburg-JCC Savings/Value^B: \$0.00 (For all items above)

WHRO Education Professional Development

WHRO Education staff members offer a wide variety of in-person and online training at no cost to HRETA Member divisions throughout the year. In 2025-26, 27 trainings were conducted on topics such as:

- AI & eMediaVA: Say Goodbye to Hours of Planning
- Integrating eMediaVA for SOL-Aligned Instruction
- Teaching News Literacy & Digital Citizenship in the Age of AI
- eMediaVA Collections: Your Toolkit for Continuous Summer Learning
- Preparing for SOL Success with eMediaVA



More than 847 educators from across the Commonwealth registered for these trainings, including approximately 338 from HRETA owner schools and 2 from Williamsburg-JCC.

Regional Savings/Value: \$109,050.00

Williamsburg-JCC Savings/Value^C: \$300.00

"Very relevant and relatable to my content area! I appreciated how it connected to my content. A Great PD session!"- Teacher, Suffolk

Cultural Competency Training Hosting

In March 2022, the VDOE requested that WHRO design and host an online cultural competency module as part of the eMediaVA contract. This content allows all Virginia educators to meet the licensure requirements outlined by the General Assembly in HB 1904 and SB 1196. WHRO continues to host the completed module on the eMediaVA server.

Regional Savings/Value: \$15,885.00

Williamsburg-JCC Savings/Value^D: \$725.00

Virginia State and Local Civic Education Hosting

At the request of the VDOE and as part of the eMediaVA contract, WHRO hosts the Virginia State and Local Civic Education Module. This online content satisfies license renewal requirements for any Virginia educator endorsed to teach middle school civics or economics, or high school government or history.

Regional Savings/Value: \$9,365.00

Williamsburg-JCC Savings/Value^E: \$430.00



WHRO Education Online Courses

WHRO's Digital Learning Team crafts innovative WHRO Education Online Courses, harnessing cutting-edge 21st-century technologies. These courses transcend traditional textbooks, embracing a dynamic blend of media-rich, interactive elements that captivate and engage. Meticulously aligned with Virginia Standards of Learning for specific subjects, these courses are tailor-made for instructor-led facilitation and are available in multiple learning management systems.

Moreover, the online content prioritizes inclusivity, adhering to accessibility standards that cater to diverse learning styles and preferences. Our commitment to a robust and intellectually stimulating online learning journey is underscored by a repertoire of diverse content delivery methods. These courses not only foster authentic experiences but also integrate the 5 C's, enabling self-assessment, reflective exploration, and profound subject matter investigation.

In our pursuit of excellence, each lesson is carefully structured to provide students with immediate corrective feedback, coupled with personal review opportunities before assessment. Our Digital Learning Team passionately upholds principles of inclusion, equity, justice, and diversity, as demonstrated through thoughtfully crafted content.

Drawing upon expertise from across the region, all course material is curated and thoroughly reviewed. Once finalized, these courses become valuable resources for participating school divisions, offering customization options to suit their unique educational needs.

Since 2007, the following courses have been developed:

- Algebra I
- Algebra II
- Algebra, Functions, and Data Analysis
- Astronomy
- Biology
- Chemistry
- Digital Citizenship
- Earth Science
- Economics and Personal Finance
- English 9
- English 10
- English 11
- English 12
- Environmental Science
- French I
- Geometry
- Health and PE 9
- Health and PE 10
- Mathematical Analysis
- Middle School Career Investigations
- Oceanography
- Online Teaching Methodology
- Physics
- Psychology
- VA and US Government
- VA and US History
- World Geography
- World History and Geography to 1500 A.D. (C.E.)
- World History and Geography: 1500 A.D. (C.E.) to the Present

In 2025-26, the Digital Learning Team updated and delivered the English 9, Math Analysis, and Algebra 2 online courses. Course versions were delivered in three different learning management systems. The team also revised the Algebra 1 video series and updated the files in eMediaVA.



During the year, WHRO submitted English 9 to be considered for the coveted Quality Matters Certification Mark. It passed this rigorous review process and was awarded the QM certification mark. English 9 makes the fifth of WHRO's courses to be submitted and approved for this honor. Quality Matters is the international leader for quality assurance in online and innovative digital teaching and learning environments. Their rigorous, extensive review process is grounded in research and best practices.

Regional Savings/Value: \$10,710,000.00

Williamsburg-JCC Savings/Value^F: \$945,000.00

VDOE Projects

During 2025-26, WHRO completed work for the VDOE in developing thirty brief animated videos highlighting the lives and achievements of historical figures identified in the second-grade History and Social Science SOL. These videos and accompanying lesson guides will assist elementary teachers as they help students meet the standards. Another History and Social Science project involved creating professional development videos for middle school teachers on how to implement inquiry-based learning. WHRO also curated grade-band collections of digital resources in eMediaVA to help teachers address the requirements under Virginia's Model Policy for Internet Safety. As part of another VDOE project, WHRO created and hosted the Standards Satchel Resource Toolkits website. This website provides resources to help teachers address the Standards of Learning with multilingual learners.

Regional Savings/Value: \$2,016,000.00

Williamsburg-JCC Savings/Value^G: \$498,539.00

WHRO Education Learning Objects

The Digital Learning Team consistently delivers exceptional online content. Notably, these resources are not only integrated within online courses but are also accessible as stand-alone learning objects on eMediaVA. This versatile approach empowers teachers and students to utilize the content independently for diverse instructional and learning purposes.

During the 2025-26 school year, 1,404 individual learning objects were seamlessly incorporated into eMediaVA, stemming from our newly developed online course content. This demonstrates our unwavering commitment to enhancing educational opportunities through accessible and resourceful content.

Regional Savings/Value: \$9,700.00

Williamsburg-JCC Savings/Value^H: \$1,285.00

Student Advisory Board

WHRO's Student Advisory Board met three times during the year and provided valuable input regarding the middle school environmental science resources being developed by WHRO. Students also created podcasts based on real-world scenarios as part of the revised content for WHRO's Algebra 1 online course.



During these Saturday meetings, 41 students hailing from eleven HRETA school divisions participated. While this endeavor is not quantified in monetary terms, its immeasurable value to WHRO's Digital Learning Team is undeniable. This partnership continually fuels our commitment to crafting content that resonates with and represents the diversity of youth.



ADDITIONAL EDUCATIONAL RESOURCES, TRAINING, AND SERVICES

Batten Environmental Education Initiative

In March 2017, the Batten Environmental Education Initiative was officially launched with a \$3 million gift from Jane Batten. During 2025-26, WHRO met with focus groups of middle school students and teachers to inform work on new SOL-aligned environmental science content. Lesson plans were developed for middle school teachers around the topic of sea level rise, and area teachers were involved in piloting those lessons. WHRO also developed the first of several environmental interactives specific to middle school students. In addition, WHRO wrapped the new middle school van and identified lesson software and material to be implemented in the van's launch during the 2026-27 school year.

PBS KIDS Writers Contest

The PBS KIDS Writers Contest, which is aligned to the Virginia Standards of Learning, encourages children to write and illustrate their own stories and is open to K-5 students. In 2018, in connection with the Batten Environmental Education Initiative, we added a separate Environmental Story category. Local winners receive cash awards and are honored during an awards ceremony. It is difficult to determine the value/savings this activity represents, but the participation of area students demonstrates its worth. In total, nearly 300 entries were received this past year.



TowneBank Regional Spelling Bee

The TowneBank Regional Spelling Bee is an annual event featuring sixth- to eighth-grade school Spelling Bee winners from Hampton Roads, Northeast North Carolina, and the Eastern Shore in a head-to-head competition that is broadcast on WHRO TV. Students representing 51 area schools as local Spelling Bee Champions competed in the WHRO studio. WHRO's production of the Spelling Bee won a bronze Telly Award in the General Television – Live category in 2018.

Great Computer Challenges

Great Computer Challenges – Junior and Senior – are joint projects of WHRO and Old Dominion University, and are competitive opportunities for students in grades K-12 to demonstrate their skills in various computer applications. Students compete in categories such as CAD, Desktop Publishing, Graphic Design, Music Composition, and Visual Programming. One hundred and thirty-nine teams registered to participate in the Challenges this year, including [eighteen Williamsburg-JCC teams](#). Unfortunately, due to the tragedy on the ODU campus, the March senior division competition scheduled for that weekend had to be canceled. However, the junior division was held as scheduled in May.

Regional Savings/Value: \$5,520.00

[Williamsburg-JCC Savings/Value¹: \\$720.00](#)

[Williamsburg-JCC Junior Division Participants and Winners:](#)

School	Teacher Sponsor(s)	Grade Level	Category	Award
Matthew Whaley Elementary	Kris Van Deusen	Level 2 - Grades 3-5	Desktop Presentations	Honorable Mention
Matthew Whaley Elementary	Kris Van Deusen	Level 2 - Grades 3-5	Graphic Design	

Matthew Whaley Elementary	Kris Van Deusen	Level 2 - Grades 3-5	Internet Scavenger Hunt	Honorable Mention
Matthew Whaley Elementary	Kris Van Deusen	Level 2 - Grades 3-5	Desktop Publishing	
Matthew Whaley Elementary	Kris Van Deusen	Level 2 - Grades 3-5	Video Editing	2nd Place
Matthew Whaley Elementary	Kris Van Deusen	Level 2 - Grades 3-5	Visual Programming/ Block Coding	
Stonehouse Elementary	Scott Brown, Jen Dale, Barbara Westlund	Level 2 - Grades 3-5	Desktop Presentations	2nd Place
Stonehouse Elementary	Scott Brown, Jen Dale, Barbara Westlund	Level 2 - Grades 3-5	Graphic Design	
Stonehouse Elementary	Scott Brown, Jen Dale, Barbara Westlund	Level 2 - Grades 3-5	Internet Scavenger Hunt	1st Place
Stonehouse Elementary	Scott Brown, Jen Dale, Barbara Westlund	Level 2 - Grades 3-5	Desktop Publishing	1st Place
Stonehouse Elementary	Scott Brown, Jen Dale, Barbara Westlund	Level 2 - Grades 3-5	Video Editing	3rd Place
Stonehouse Elementary	Scott Brown, Jen Dale, Barbara Westlund	Level 2 - Grades 3-5	Visual Programming/ Block Coding	
Norge Elementary	Mandy Collier, Jessica Renner	Level 2 - Grades 3-5	Desktop Presentations	
Norge Elementary	Mandy Collier, Jessica Renner	Level 2 - Grades 3-5	Graphic Design	
Norge Elementary	Mandy Collier, Jessica Renner	Level 2 - Grades 3-5	Internet Scavenger Hunt	
Norge Elementary	Mandy Collier, Jessica Renner	Level 2 - Grades 3-5	Desktop Publishing	
Norge Elementary	Mandy Collier, Jessica Renner	Level 2 - Grades 3-5	Video Editing	
Norge Elementary	Mandy Collier, Jessica Renner	Level 2 - Grades 3-5	Visual Programming/ Block Coding	1st Place

WHRO Education Staff Member Presentations

WHRO Education staff members presented or exhibited at the following Local, Regional, Statewide, or National Events: Virginia Association for Supervision and Curriculum Development (VASCD) Annual Conference; Virginia Association for the Education of Young Children (VAAEYC) Conference; Virginia Association of School Librarians (VAASL) Regional Conference; Virginia Association of Science Teachers (VAST) Conference; Virginia School Board Association (VSBA); Virginia Society for Technology in Education (VSTE) Annual Conference; the Virginia Association for Independent Schools (VAIS) Annual Conference; the Virginia Art Education Association (VAEA) Annual Conference; the Virginia Department of Education (VDOE) Statewide Meeting; and Region 2 Assistant Superintendents of Instruction meetings.

In addition, WHRO Education staff conducted training for Chesapeake Public Schools, Fauquier County Public Schools, Louisa County Public Schools, Newport News Public Schools, Norfolk Public Schools, Poquoson City Schools, and Suffolk Public Schools.

WHRO KIDS

WHRO KIDS is WHRO's 24/7 digital children's channel, airing on WHRO TV 15-3, Cox 108, FIOS 462, and Charter 120. In early 2017, this service was expanded to include a 24/7 streaming option that can be used on any mobile device. Featuring newer, award-winning early childhood programs such as Donkey Hodie, Work It Out Wombats, Rosie's Rules, Alma's Way, Nature Cat, Odd Squad, Daniel Tiger's Neighborhood, Xavier Riddle and the Secret Museum, Wild Kratts, Pinkalicious, Molly of Denali, Lyla in the Loop, Elinor Wonders Why, Let's Go Luna!, Hero Elementary, and perennial favorites Sesame Street, Curious George, and Clifford The Big Red Dog, to name a few, WHRO delivered more than 160 hours of the best high-quality educational television programming each and every week, free of charge. WHRO also delivered more than 65 hours of children's programming each week on our main channel WHRO 15.1.

In total, WHRO delivered more than 12,000 hours of televised instruction last year. Every household in the WHRO service area can access this proven educational programming that helps parents prepare their children to enter school ready to learn, free of charge. Consequently, the true value is significantly more than the operational costs reported here.

Regional Savings/Value: \$275,000.00

Williamsburg-JCC Savings/Value^d: \$12,580.00

General PBS Programming

General PBS programming with full educational rights, such as American Experience, Nova, Nature, etc., is delivered each week on our main channel WHRO 15.1, and can be recorded and used in the classroom. Detailed local usage figures are unavailable, but according to national statistics, more than 30% of teachers use PBS programs in their classrooms.

Regional Savings/Value: \$217,615.00

Williamsburg-JCC Savings/Value^k: \$7,695.00

Local Educational Productions

The quarterly call-in radio show, Education Matters, returned to the airwaves on WHRV for a third year. School division superintendents from around the region appeared on the show and fielded questions from listeners regarding timely issues in education. Education Now video segments featuring successful school practices were produced for Accomack County, Northampton County, and Virginia Beach. Education Now videos are aired throughout the year on WHRO TV15, WHRO WORLD, and WHRO CREATE. Other local educational video productions included the TowneBank Spelling Bee, the 2026 streaming of the Young Storytellers Awards Ceremony, and 9 new Ms. Martha Reads weekly literacy streaming episodes. The GreenBeats and HealthBeats series also aired throughout the year. In addition, WHRO continued to work with the VSBA to stream their Legislative Advocacy Conference, Annual Convention, and School Law Conference to allow school board members to view these events from remote locations.

Regional Savings/Value: \$213,920.00

Williamsburg-JCC Savings/Value^l: \$8,400.00

National Public Radio

National Public Radio (NPR) regularly covers educational topics within major shows such as Morning Edition, All Things Considered, Talk of the Nation, etc. In 2025-26, nearly 250 stories touched on education topics, representing more than 2% of the total number of stories covered.

Regional Savings/Value: \$13,535.00

Williamsburg-JCC Savings/Value^M: \$660.00

Workplace Readiness

Five **Workplace Readiness Modules** developed by WHRO are available to all HRETA school divisions free of charge. These modules cover the following topics:

- Applied Mathematics
- Internet Use and Safety
- Locating Information
- Reading for Information
- Understanding Health, Wellness, and Safety

WHRO Education's Achievements and Recognition

In 2025-26, WHRO Education enjoyed remarkable success at the 56th Annual Public Media Awards ceremony, winning the prestigious Innovation in Education award.

Williamsburg-James City County Public Schools

Return on WHRO Investment

2025-26

WHRO directly impacts:

- 1) Educators by providing ongoing, sustained, high-quality teacher training; innovative, technology-based instructional resources; and regional opportunities for recognition.
- 2) Students by providing online courses, on-demand digital resources, educationally relevant competitions, and regional opportunities for recognition.
- 3) Families by providing the highest quality children's programming 24 hours per day, seven days per week, as well as a variety of online resources and face-to-face, hands-on early childhood workshops.

In summary, WHRO educational efforts directly affect not only the schools' bottom lines, but also the quality of education for every single educator, student, adult learner, and family in Hampton Roads. Exemplary educators and initiatives are regularly publicized on air, online, and in person.

Williamsburg-JCC Annual Investment in WHRO **\$40,710.52**

Direct Value/Savings:

eMediaVA Operation and Content Acquisition	\$47,985.00
Families and Early Learners	\$0.00
WHRO Education Professional Development	\$300.00
Cultural Competency Training Hosting	\$725.00
Virginia State and Local Civic Education Hosting	\$430.00
WHRO Education Online Courses	\$945,000.00
VDOE Requested Projects	\$498,539.00
WHRO Education Learning Objects	\$1,285.00

Total Direct Annual Value/Savings **\$1,494,264.00**

Williamsburg-JCC Direct Return on Investment **\$36.70 to \$1.00**

Additional Value/Savings:

Great Computer Challenges (Junior and Senior Divisions)	\$720.00
WHRO KIDS	\$12,580.00
General PBS Programming	\$7,695.00
Local Educational Video Productions	\$8,400.00
General NPR Programming	\$660.00

Total Additional Annual Value/Savings **\$30,055.00**

Total Direct and Additional Annual Value/Savings **\$1,524,319.00**

Total Williamsburg-JCC Return on Investment **\$37.45 to \$1.00**

Value/Savings Calculations

- A Comparable service value (\$850 per building) multiplied by the number of buildings in each HRETA division, plus content licensing fees (\$29,450) and playlist creation (\$2,000) multiplied by the number of WHRO owner school divisions (21) to yield the regional value.
- B Number of training sessions or classroom lessons conducted multiplied by the average cost per session or lesson (\$750 each) plus number of camps conducted multiplied by cost to conduct them (\$1,000-\$5,000 each) plus number of appearances or events multiplied by the cost to conduct them (\$250-\$1,000 each) throughout the region plus the number of PBS characters multiplied by the costs to obtain and employ them (\$1,000 each) plus the cost of developing new WHRO Library Corners (\$2,300 each) plus the cost of materials distributed.
- C Number of division registrations multiplied by an average session registration cost of \$150.
- D Cultural Competency Training hosting costs allocated across HRETA owners according to relative size.
- E Virginia State and Local Civic Education hosting costs allocated across HRETA owners according to relative size.
- F 2025-26 WHRO online course development costs to create or refresh courses and create new learning management system versions of courses (\$510,000) multiplied by the number of WHRO owner school divisions (21) to yield the regional value.
- G The combined value of the four VDOE projects (\$498,539) multiplied by the number of WHRO owner school divisions (21) to yield the regional value.
- H WHRO Education learning objects ingestion costs (\$28,080) allocated across HRETA owners according to relative size.
- I Number of division teams multiplied by HRETA member entry fee discount.
- J Total annual operational cost (\$275,000) of WHRO KIDS allocated across HRETA owners according to relative size.
- K Annual WHRO PBS dues (\$841,012) multiplied by 20% (conservative estimated educational percentage of program usage) allocated across HRETA owners according to relative size.
- L 2026 WHRO Public Media Spelling Bee production and broadcast costs (\$77,180) plus 2026 Young Storytellers production costs (\$31,892) plus Ms. Martha Reads production costs (\$10,625) plus VSBA Conference and Convention production costs (\$4,000) plus VSTE Conference production costs (\$2,000) plus GreenBeats broadcast costs (\$33,653) plus HealthBeat broadcast costs (\$10,655) all allocated across HRETA owners according to relative size. Education Now production costs are allocated to the divisions for which the spots are produced (\$8,450).
- M Annual WHRO NPR dues (\$14,390) multiplied by 2% (based on NPR statistics regarding the number of programs directly related to Education) allocated across HRETA owners according to relative size.

Notes

Educational Advisory Committee

The Educational Advisory Committee (EAC) consists of a division-selected School Board member or designee from each HRETA Member division. The EAC receives reports, updates, and other information related to educational issues and priorities. The EAC meets four times each year at WHRO, usually in October, December, March, and May. The EAC is the decision-making body on matters related to the policy, planning, and operation of WHRO public education-related activities.

Superintendents Advisory Council

The Superintendents Advisory Council (SAC) consists of HRETA Member superintendents. Because school divisions are the owners of WHRO, this group of superintendents serves as the body that makes final recommendations to the EAC regarding decisions related to the policy, planning, and operation of WHRO public education-related activities. The SAC meets five times each year at WHRO, usually in October, December, January, March, and May. The SAC chair may schedule additional meetings as needed. The SAC receives reports on various issues pertaining to WHRO, as well as summary reports regarding budgets, grants, instructional-related services, and other business matters associated with educational initiatives supporting public schools.

Technology Advisory Committee

The Technology Advisory Committee (TAC) consists of HRETA Member Chief Information Officers or other Superintendent designees from each division. The TAC reviews all aspects of established educational activities (including budgets, grants, new initiatives, etc.) and provides comments on any related issues or concerns. Additionally, the TAC works with WHRO staff to recommend new regional technology-based directives and initiatives and provides written reports to the SAC. The Consortium for Interactive Instruction (C.I.I.) serves as a resource to the TAC, providing detailed information on their area of responsibility and recommendations, if any, relative to their activities. The TAC meets five times a year, usually in September, November, January, March, and May. Additional meetings may be scheduled as determined by the TAC Chair.

Consortium for Interactive Instruction

The Consortium for Interactive Instruction (C.I.I.) consists of HRETA Member representatives who are appointed by the division Superintendent. The C.I.I. serves as a subcommittee for the TAC to facilitate the communication, implementation, forums, and other activities essential to collaboration regarding instructional technologies in the HRETA region. C.I.I. business meetings are held three times a year, usually in September, January, and May, with additional special interest forums scheduled as needed throughout the year.

Online Learning System Administrators Committee

The Online Learning System Administrator Committee is composed of school division representatives and WHRO Education personnel. These individuals serve as learning management system administrators and meet together to support online and blended learning. Online Learning System Administrator meetings are held regularly throughout the year.